

# WHERE ARE AUSTRALIA'S NEXT COMMUNITY CRICKETERS?

A public-data decision-support prototype for community cricket participation growth

Executive Brief | Md Musa | August 2026

**BUSINESS QUESTION** If Australian Cricket has limited acquisition resources, which communities deserve deeper investigation first - and why?

**Decision takeaway:** screen demographic opportunity first, diagnose cricket readiness second, then choose the intervention.

|               |           |               |                                  |
|---------------|-----------|---------------|----------------------------------|
| 365           | 17        | 18            | 94.6%                            |
| Eligible LGAs | Very High | Robust Top-20 | Top-20 growth in 4 major systems |

## MODEL V1

Equal-weighted percentile pillars: **Market Size**, **Youth Concentration**, and **Growth Momentum** (absolute + percentage five-year junior growth).

### TOP 5 OPPORTUNITY POTENTIAL

| Rank | LGA            | Score |
|------|----------------|-------|
| 1    | Wyndham, VIC   | 99.27 |
| 2    | Melton, VIC    | 98.22 |
| 3    | Blacktown, NSW | 97.21 |
| 4    | Ipswich, QLD   | 96.58 |
| 5    | Camden, NSW    | 96.39 |

## STRONGEST FINDINGS

- Market size alone is misleading: total population and junior market size are almost the same signal (Spearman  $\approx 0.99$ ).
- Junior growth adds distinct information (overall vs junior growth  $\approx 0.57$ ), supporting a separate Growth Momentum pillar.
- Four major growth systems - outer Melbourne, western/south-west Sydney, South East Queensland and Perth - account for 94.6% of the Top-20 absolute junior-population increase.

## WHAT CRICKET AUSTRALIA SHOULD DO

### 1. Build Opportunity $\times$ Readiness prioritisation

Use Model V1 to choose where to investigate, then add registrations, club/program supply, facilities and capacity before allocating resources.

### 2. Plan by growth corridor, not only LGA

Coordinate adjacent high-growth areas as shared participation systems, especially across the four major growth corridors.

### 3. Separate acquisition, conversion, retention and capacity

Track first-time registrations, return rates, Blast-to-club conversion, waitlists and facility utilisation - not just total participation.

## CASE-STUDY SIGNALS

- Wyndham:** capacity audit + targeted acquisition  
**Blacktown:** potential capacity-constrained priority  
**Ipswich:** activate around new capacity  
**Armadale:** validate demand before scaling  
**Maitland:** regional growth activation

### IMPORTANT LIMITATION

Model V1 is a relative demographic screening tool. It does not measure actual cricket demand, participation penetration, future registrations, or national Cricket System Readiness.